

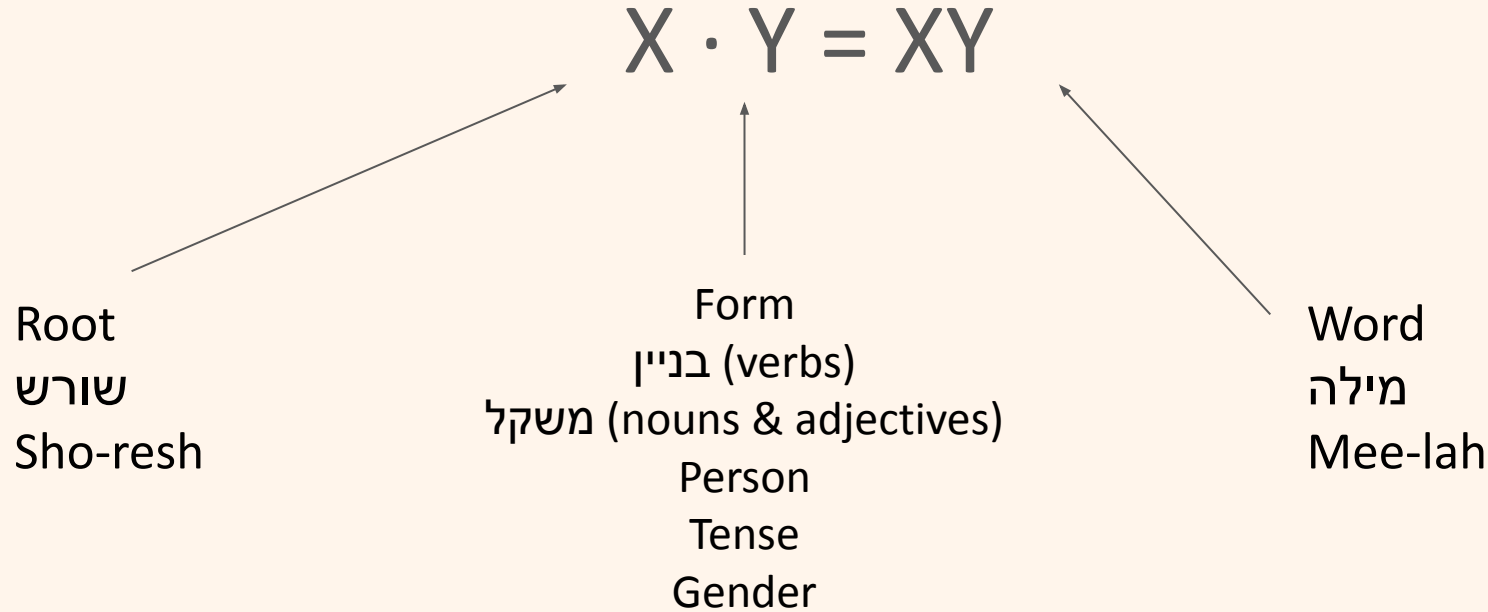
Buildings & Weights: The Other Half of Every Hebrew Word



Why Is This Both So Important *and* Hardly Taught?

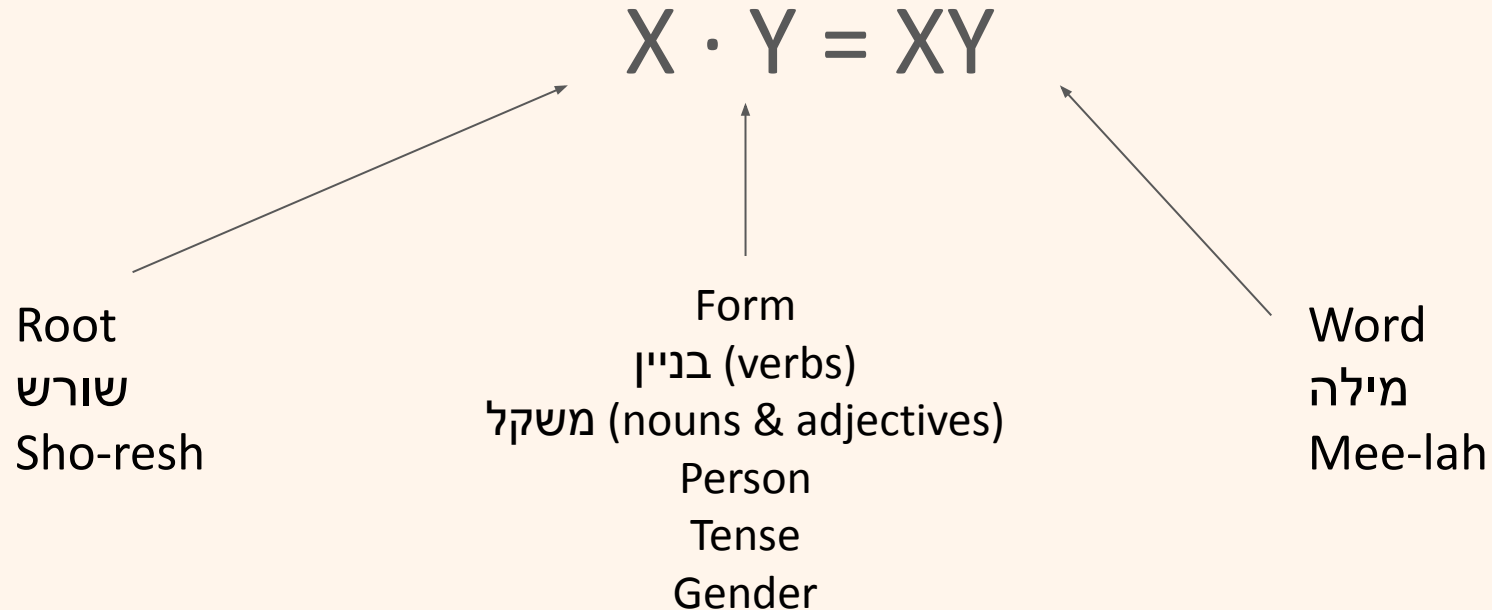
- Learning to recognize the forms of words will help comprehension in general, and reading without nikkud (diacritical marks for vowel sounds) in particular
- For those who think spatially and/or are math-friendly, Modern Hebrew is a game-changer in language acquisition
- Hebrew is infinitely more logical and predictable than certain Indo-European languages – that includes creating words
- Why & how we learn Hebrew is still at odds with everyday life in Israel
 - Modern Hebrew is related to yet different from “Religious” Hebrew
 - Formal education has not caught up with Western audiences being the primary pool of current & future learners, and thus their pedagogies, ie Hebrew is meant to be learned for immediate application rather than (and in addition) for long-term mastery

Hebrew is a lot like 7th Grade Algebra



כ.ת.ב.ב. בניין פעל, שם פועל = לְכַתּוֹב

כ.ת.ב.ב. משקל מְקַטֵּל, יחיד = מְכַתֵּב



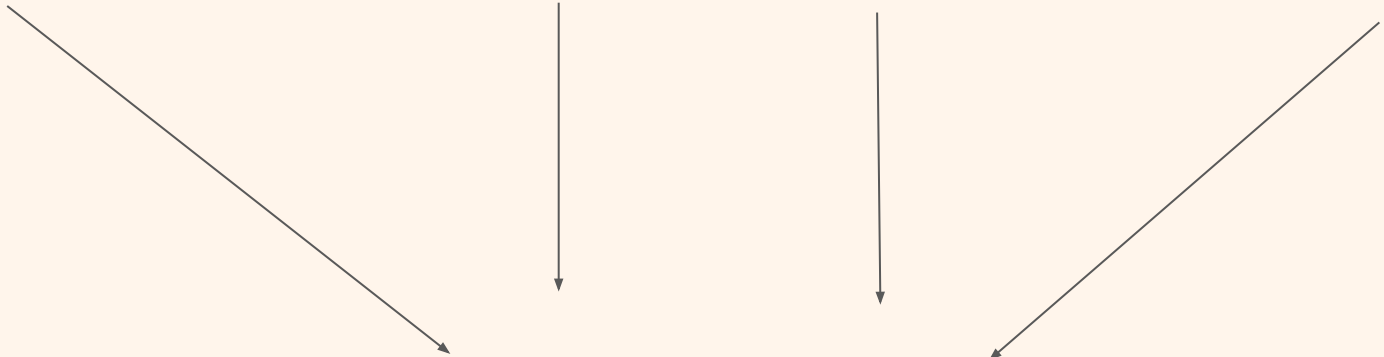
Root
שורש
Sho-resch



Form
(verbs) בניין
(nouns משקל
& adjectives)



הוא האכיל את האוכל האכיל למי שאוכל.



א.כ.ל

א-כ-ל, אכ"ל

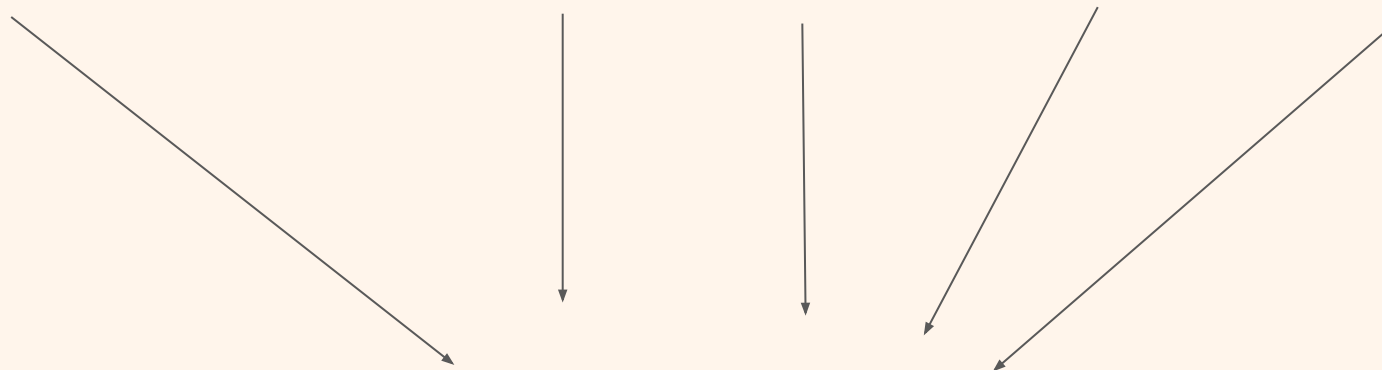
הוא האכיל את האוכל האכיל למי שאוכל.

Subject	He	הוא	Hoo
Verb, past causative 3rd person sing. m	fed	האכיל	heh-eh-cheel
Direct object	the food	את האוכל	et ha-oh-chehl
Modifying adjective	the/that's edible	האכיל	ha-ah-cheel
Preposition + object pronoun	to whomever	למי	leh-mee
Present participle, Verb, present simple 3rd person sing m.	is eating.	שאוכל	sheh-oh-chehl

הוא האכיל את האוכל למי שאוכל.

Subject	He	הוא	Hoo
Hif'il, past 3rd singular	fed	האכיל	heh-eh-cheel
kotel pattern, singular	the food	את האוכל	et ha-oh-chehl
katil pattern, singular masculine	the/that's edible	האכיל	ha-ah-cheel
Preposition + object pronoun	to whomever	למי	leh-mee
Present participle, Pa'al, 3rd person singular masculine	is eating.	שאוכל	sheh-oh-chehl

הַמְּכַתְּבִים הַכְּתוּבִים נִכְתְּבוּ בְּכֶתֶב עַל יְדֵי הַכֹּתֵב.



כ.ת.ב

כ-ת-ב, כת"ב

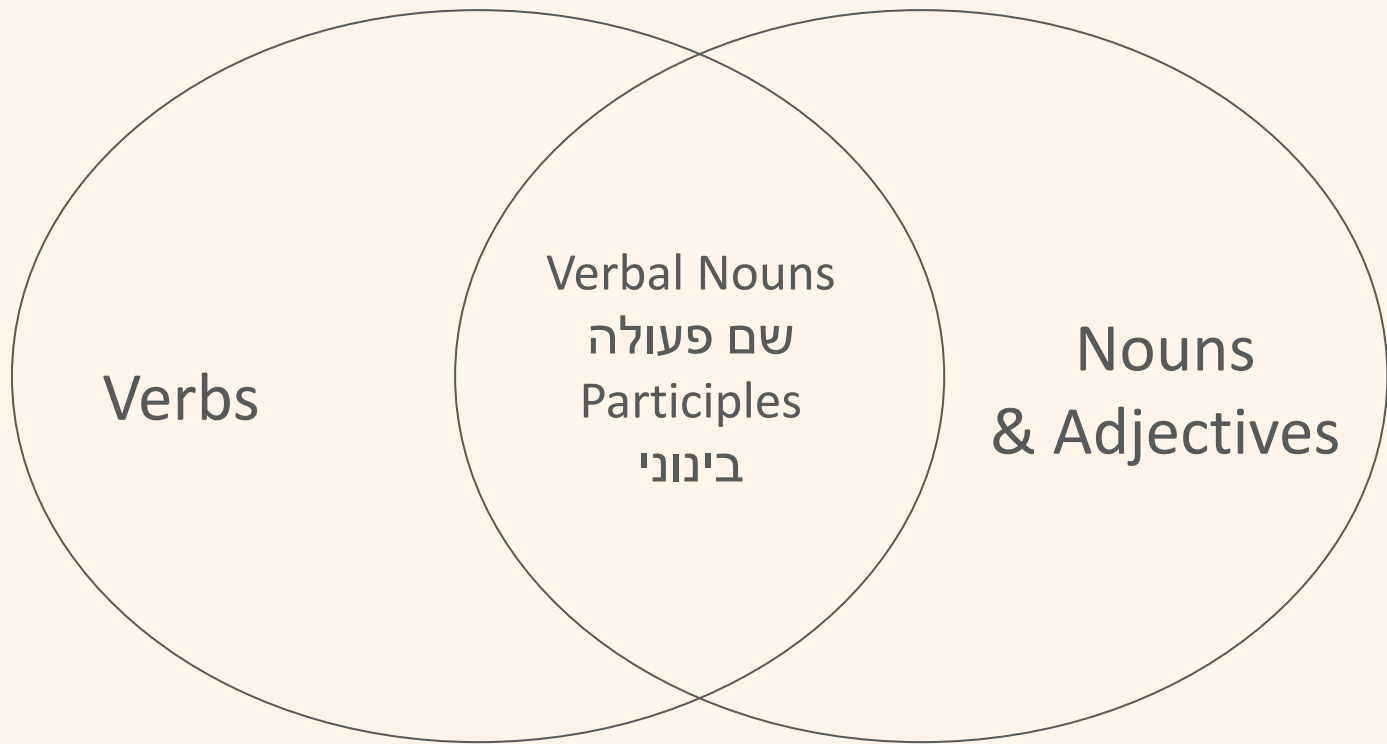
הַמִּכְתָּבִים הַכְּתוּבִים נִכְתְּבוּ בְּכֶתֶב עַל יְדֵי הַכֹּתֵב.

miktal pattern, plural masculine	The letters	הַמִּכְתָּבִים	ha-meech-tah-veem
katul pattern, Plural masculine	the/that are written	הַכְּתוּבִים	hahk-too-veem
Nif'al, past 3rd person pl m	were written	נִכְתְּבוּ	neech-tah-veem
Preposition + ktal pattern	in script handwriting	בְּכֶתֶב	beech-tahv
Preposition	by	עַל יְדֵי	ahl yeh-day
kattal pattern, singular masculine	the journalist	הַכֹּתֵב	ha-kah-tahv

The diagram consists of two light blue ovals on a light orange background. The left oval contains text about verbs, and the right oval contains text about nouns and adjectives.

Verbs
Binyanim
Seven Forms
פעל

Nouns & Adjectives
Mishkalim
Hundreds of Forms
קטל



Why is correct spelling so important in Hebrew?

- Hebrew words are created from the combination of a root (shoh-resh) and a form (been-yahn for verbs, meesh-kahl for nouns & adjectives), making correct spelling crucial for understanding
- As a result, homophonic letters cannot be swapped in spelling, as it may create a complete different word

לכתוב, כ.ת.ב.

leech-tove

To write

לחטוב, ח.ט.ב.

lahch-tove

To chop (ie wood)

Meesh-kahl: The Other Half Of Every Noun & Adjective



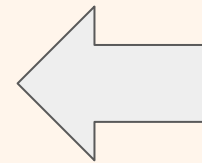
- All Hebrew nouns and adjectives have two components:
 - Root
 - Meesh-kahl
- Just like binyanim for verbs, mishkalim come with their own meanings
 - Places = **מִקְטָלָה**
 - Tools = **מִקְטִילָה**
 - -able/-ible = **קְטִיל**

מסגרת
מקלדת
מרשתת

ר.ג.ו

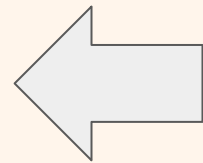
ק.ל.ד

ר.ש.ת



מקטל

ת



מסגרת

מקלדת

~~מחשבת~~

Framework

Keyboard

~~Internet~~

“Close”

“Pressed-upon key”

Net

Why didn't מרשתת catch?

- Not the easiest / aesthetically-pleasing to pronounce
- Unless quickly adopted by “mavens” and “connectors,” new things made abroad tend to keep their “abroad” name
- Its root had & still has only one application

Helper Prefixes & Suffixes



Prefix	Suffix
Conjunctions & Prepositions ב, ה, ו, כ, כש, ל, מ, ש	
Participle מ	Participle: Gender & Plural, Diminutive ה, ון, י, יה, ית, ת
	Possession י, יי, ר, יר, ו, יו, ה, יה, נו, ינו, כם, יכם, כן, יכן, ם, ן, יהם, יהן
	Past Tense Verbs: Gender & Plural תי, ת, ה, נו, תם, תן, ו
Present Tense Verbs (some) מ	Present Tense Verbs: Gender & Plural ה, ת, ים, ות
Future Tense Verbs: Person א, ת, י, נ	Future Tense: Gender & Plural י, ו

Takeaway rules for determining the shoresh & mishkal

1. Deep breath, go at your own pace
2. Find the words you definitely know how to pronounce, they're your "anchors"
- 3a. Move on to the words next to your anchors -- do they have any helper prefixes & suffixes that indicate meaning and/or form? Do you know words that partially rhyme with it?
- 3b. What's the root of the word you don't know? Do you know words with a similar root?
4. Sound out the words you don't know, based on what you've learned and what it would sound like if a native Israeli were speaking